FOR FIRST-TIME FOUNDERS

Do the angel's math before the call.

Four steps. The arithmetic is on every slide.



Claudius Taylor

@theeClaudius

I coach founders.

1

First, know your raise number.

Start from the months you need. Say burn and months out loud.



- **Monthly burn times months to the milestone**
- **Example: $25K x 20 months = $500K**

Show the multiplication

Illustrative figures. Arithmetic shown on the slide.


Claudius Taylor @theeClaudius

2

Second, know the slice you sell.

Dilution is one division. Post-money is value after the raise.

- **Raise divided by post-money = share sold**
- **Example: $500K / $5M = 10%**



- **Know the percentage before they ask**

Illustrative figures. Arithmetic shown on the slide.

 **Claudius Taylor** @theeClaudius

THE SHIFT

The angel runs different math than you.

You count months of runway. They ask what their slice is worth if it works.



Claudius Taylor @theeClaudius

THIRD, THE ANGEL'S SIDE

0.5%

a $25K check

$25K / $5M = 0.5% of the company.

0.5% of a $50M company is $250K. That is 10x the check, before later rounds dilute it.

Know what the company must be worth

Illustrative figures. Arithmetic shown on the slide.


Claudius Taylor @theeClaudius

4

Fourth, name what the money proves.

The raise buys one thing. Say what it is.



One milestone, stated as a number

Paying customers or revenue, never a vague feeling.

Reachable inside the months you raised

If it needs more time, the raise is too small.

Something the next investor can check

A record they can verify beats a promise.

No milestone, no raise

 Claudius Taylor @theeClaudius

Now, say it in one breath.

The raise: $500K for 20 months

Burn times months.

The slice: 10% at a $5M post-money

One division.

The proof: one milestone by month 20

A number they can check.

Practice it out loud. No slides.

Illustrative figures. Arithmetic shown on the slides.


Claudius Taylor @theeClaudius

Run the math on paper before the call.

Raise, slice, milestone. One breath.

Repost for a founder preparing a first raise



Claudius Taylor

@theeClaudius

I coach founders.